

Amendment No. 1 to SJR0017

Bulso
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Joint Resolution No. 17*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of United States President Jimmy Carter; and

WHEREAS, President Carter was a man of deep faith, a humanitarian of the highest order, and a true exemplar of servant-hearted leadership as a way of life; and

WHEREAS, James Earl Carter, Jr., was born on October 1, 1924, in Plains, Georgia, the eldest child of James Earl Carter, Sr., and Bessie Lillian Gordy Carter, who together started a peanut business; and

WHEREAS, after high school, Jimmy Carter graduated with distinction from the U.S. Naval Academy in 1946, ranking in the top 10% of his class and thereafter distinguished himself in the U.S. Navy under the command of Admiral Hyman Rickover as a pioneer in the operation of nuclear-powered submarines; and

WHEREAS, after having served in the U.S. Navy for seven years and having been honorably discharged on October 9, 1953, he returned to Plains, Georgia, to run the family farm upon the death of his father; he was thus a peanut farmer when he entered politics on the ground floor, achieving election to local school and library boards before becoming a member of the Georgia State Senate; and

WHEREAS, he served two terms as a state senator before being elected as Georgia's 76th Governor, a post he held from 1971 to 1975; in his inaugural speech, at a time when desegregation and civil rights remained tinderbox issues, Jimmy Carter declared that "the time

for racial discrimination is over," and during his time as governor, he ensured that African Americans were appointed to public offices; and

WHEREAS, although his bid for the presidency initially polled at four-percent support from fellow Democrats, he made political history by going from "Jimmy Who?" to winning the 1976 Iowa Caucuses, securing the Democratic nomination, and toppling incumbent Gerald Ford to become the 39th President of the United States, serving in the country's highest office from 1977 to 1981; and

WHEREAS, in response to the economic crisis created by the Arab oil embargo and the nation's growing dependence on foreign oil, President Carter called for a comprehensive campaign to conserve energy and, as a part of that, signed the Department of Energy Organization Act on August 4, 1977; and

WHEREAS, his legacy also includes brokering peace between Israel and Egypt, inviting Egyptian President Anwar Sadat and Israeli Prime Minister Menachem Begin to Camp David in September 1978; the meeting resulted in the Camp David Accords, which ended the war between the two countries and garnered Egypt's formal recognition of Israel as an independent state; and

WHEREAS, on January 19, 1981, following a terrorist attack on the U.S. Embassy in Tehran, Iran, in which 53 Americans were taken hostage and held for 444 days; President Carter secured the safe release of the hostages through his tireless efforts and the execution of the Algiers Accords; and

WHEREAS, President Carter was universally recognized by Republicans and Democrats alike as a statesman who, as his successor President Reagan stated in his October 1, 1986, address at the dedication of the Carter Presidential Center in Atlanta, Georgia, modeled the fundamental values of hard work, perseverance, loyalty, and family that made our nation flourish and grow great; and

WHEREAS, President Carter was an early advocate for the development and use of solar power and installed solar panels at the White House in 1979; and

WHEREAS, President Carter, who created the U.S. Department of Education on October 17, 1979, expanded the Head Start program to include an additional 43,000 children and families, saw that the United States Foreign Service lifted its ban on gay and lesbian personnel, became the first President to discuss an end to discrimination in the federal government on the basis of sexual orientation, and is rightly regarded as a person of integrity and candor who kept his campaign promises; and

WHEREAS, his presidency was marked by his support of women, including his appointment of women to key positions within his administration and encouragement of his wife, Rosalynn Carter, to maintain a national profile as First Lady; he also championed an equal rights amendment to the U.S. Constitution; and

WHEREAS, in his post-presidency years, having established the Carter Presidential Center to promote and expand human rights, leading to his receipt of a Nobel Peace Prize in 2002, he also became a key figure in Habitat for Humanity, volunteering with the nonprofit alongside his wife beginning in 1984. The Carter Work Project at Habitat for Humanity touched lives around the world. The Carter Work Project, with the aid of 108,100 volunteers, built 4,447 homes for those in need in fourteen countries, including the United States, Canada, Mexico, South Africa, Hungary, India, South Korea, The Philippines, and Vietnam, among others; and

WHEREAS, President Carter was deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he enjoyed the loving companionship of his beloved wife of seventy-seven years, Rosalynn Smith Carter, who preceded him in death in 2023; together they were blessed with four children, Jack, James "Chip" III, Donnel, and Amy; twelve grandchildren; and thirteen great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, President Jimmy Carter leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life; he graced the White House with passion, intellect, and commitment, and showed compassion and loyalty in private life and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of United States President Jimmy Carter, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his legacy of compassionate service.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.